Logo UX Design Study

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UX Research Method

- Collect feedback to redesign a logo
- Understand users behaviors, needs, and preferences
- Three kinds of questions:
  - Visceral (first reaction), behavioral (what would you do), reflective
- Participants are anonymous
  - Record interview only to generate a transcript
- See each logo once, and then reflect on all three at the end of interview

The purpose of this research method was to remain neutral and make the experience as identical as possible for all the participants. The same script was used for every participant, and follow-up questions or reactions were limited, to ensure identical experiences and reduced bias for each interview.

Meet the participants

User #1:

Age: 15-25
Gender: Female
Occupations: Student, Texas Roadhouse Server, Pitt Program Council Receptionist

Gave the most detailed feedback, related each logo to existing brands.

User #2:

Age: 25-40
Gender: Female
Occupation: Grad student, Campus Programs Administrative Manager

Was the most hesitant, asked what questions mean or apologized when being critical.

User #3:

Age: 15-25
Gender: Female
Occupation: Student

Gave the most repetitive answers, seemed the least interested.

Participant insights

- All three participants identified the flower logo (Logo 3) as the most trustworthy. It was the unanimous favorite.
  - *As a part of the reflective questions, each participant was asked to identify the most professional, the most trustworthy, and just their overall favorite logo.*
- The participants associated the logos with different industries.
  - Logo 1 was seen as a clothing brand or old store, Logo 2 was linked to food or after-school activities, and Logo 3 was viewed as a coffee shop, boutique, or nature-themed brand.
- The second logo was frequently described as "plain" or "boring"
  - *This was the only logo to use a white (or cream) background instead of the greenish yellow.*
- Reactions to the color palette were mixed. Some participants enjoyed the blue and white , there was significant criticism of the yellowish-green color, which was described as making one user feel "empty" and another "overwhelmed", except for the third user that said it incited “joy”.
- All participants felt the logos successfully represented me as an individual, with the third logo specifically noted for matching my "inviting" personality and interest in sustainability.

Final logo design:

- Used a lighter, less overwhelming shade of yellow that is closer to a “true” yellow.
- Made the font larger to avoid a "blurry" or "not bold" look.
- Centered and bolded the “big ideas” text to give it a more modern look.

(Boilerplate)
Thank you for agreeing to participate in my UX research project. We'll look at three logo designs, and I'll ask you questions that will help me gather data about the effectiveness of the logo based off of first glance. I am conducting this interview under the instruction of Professor Stephen Quigley in his Integrating Writing and Design course at the University of Pittsburgh. I will record this interview for the purposes of generating a transcript. I will delete your recording after the transcript is completed. Do you have any questions? Do you agree to these terms?

(No response) Thank you for your consideration. I hope you have a great day.
(Yes response) Great, let's get started. I'm going to start the recording. (Start recording.)

Please state your occupation and age range group between the ages of 15-25, 25-40, 40-50.
Now I will show you the first of three logos.
(Show first logo)
Visceral Questions
Where do your eyes land after looking at the design?
What was your first feeling when you saw this logo?
What is your immediate reaction to the colors in this logo?
How do you feel about the use of shapes within the logo?
Behavioral Questions
Does anything feel out of place or unnecessary?
Would you click on this logo if it was a thumbnail for a social media page or an advertisement?
What do the colors and fonts make you feel?
If you saw this logo in public, would you want to learn more about the brand? Why or why not?
Now I will show you the secnond/third logo and repeat these questions.
(Repeat all above questions for second and third logo, then show the slide with all three logos and proceed to reflective questions).
Now that you have seen all 3 logos, I want you to compare them a bit.
Reflective Questions
What does each logo make you think of?
Are any of these logos repetitive?
Which logo feels the most trustworthy?
Which logo feels the most professional?
Does the purpose of these logos come across clearly to represent me as an individual?
Do you think any of the logos would have a stronger or weaker impact on you if you encountered them in a different setting (online vs. in-store/physical)? How so?
Do you prefer simpler logo designs?
Which logo is your favorite?

Interview transcripts:
https://bit.ly/4thhrxI

Interview script:
https://bit.ly/3Zg1Ukg